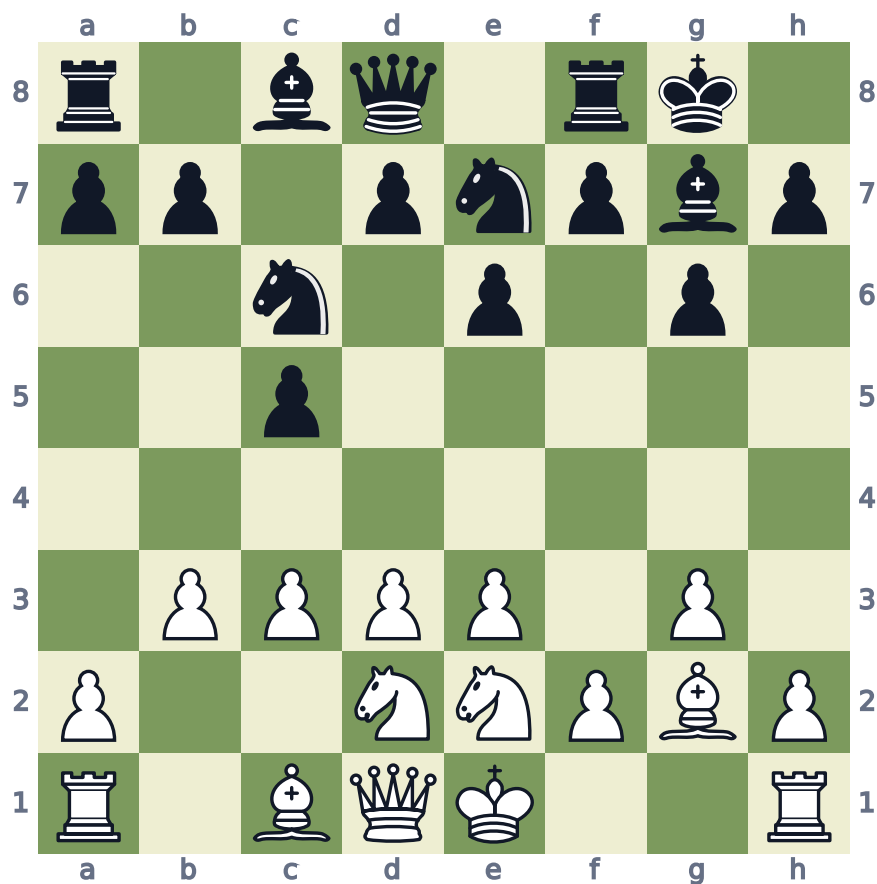


White Hippo vs Sicilian and c5 Structures

c5 pressure, reversed English positions, d5 breaks, and long-diagonal safety



Use the White Hippo against c5 setups while preventing long-diagonal tactics and selecting the right central occupation.

8 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Use the White Hippo against c5 setups while preventing long-diagonal tactics and selecting the right central occupation.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Against c5, White can choose e4, c4, or d4 according to Black's setup.

PRINCIPLE 2

The g7 bishop may attack a1 if White plays b3 without c3 or a rook move.

PRINCIPLE 3

Black's d5 break is the main central equalizer in many reversed-English structures.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

c3 can support d4 and close the long diagonal.

PRINCIPLE 5

An early e4 may transpose into a Closed Sicilian.

PRINCIPLE 6

A reversed opening gives White a tempo, not permission to ignore Black's counterplay.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

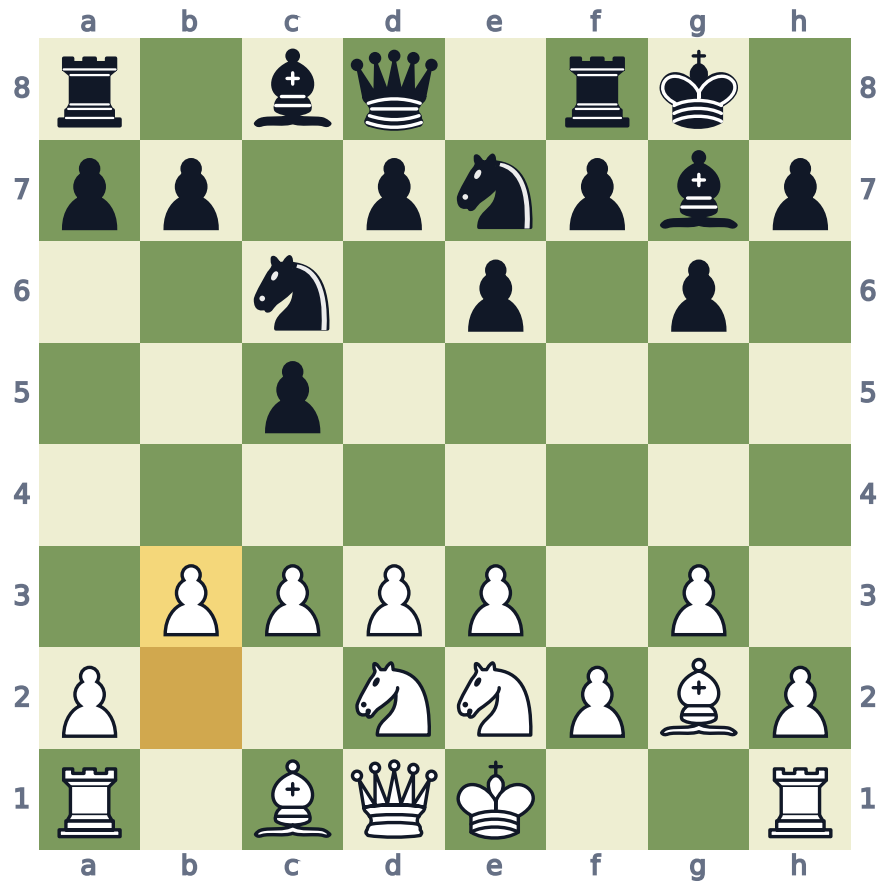
- | | | |
|-----------|--------------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Sicilian fianchetto core | Close the long diagonal before b3. |
|
 | | |
| 02 | Sicilian with e6 and d5 | Against e6-d5, e4 fixes a target and keeps f4 available. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | Sicilian with d6 and g6 | A slow Sicilian setup gives choice, not unlimited time. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | Immediate g6 setup | Against the accelerated fianchetto, count tempi to d5. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | Sicilian with Nf6 and d5 | When Nf6 supports d5, contact the center immediately. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Sicilian queenside fianchetto | Before b6, Black must block the diagonal; White should punish the move order if not. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Sicilian f5 structure | Against f5, central clarity is safer than passive shell-building. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Reversed Closed Sicilian | c4-e4 controls d5 but creates a long-term d4 hole. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Sicilian fianchetto core



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 g6 4. Nd2 Bg7 5. e3 e6 6. Ne2 Nge7 7. c3 O-O 8. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

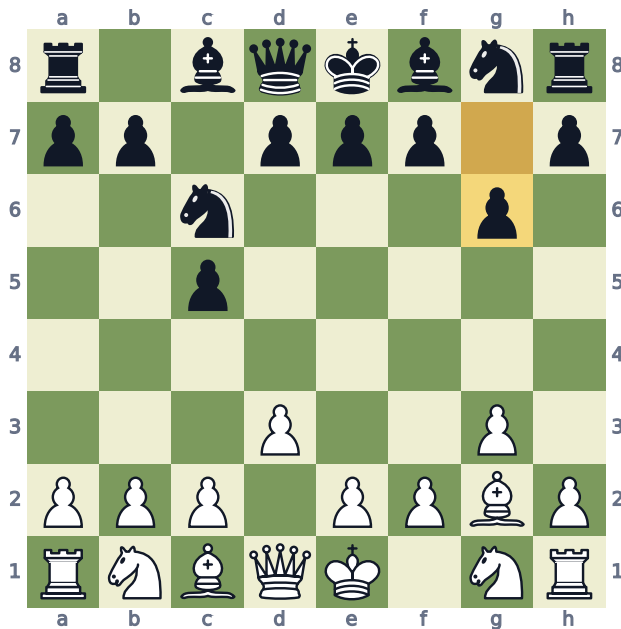
Use c3 to secure a1 and prepare d4 or e4.

MAIN DANGER

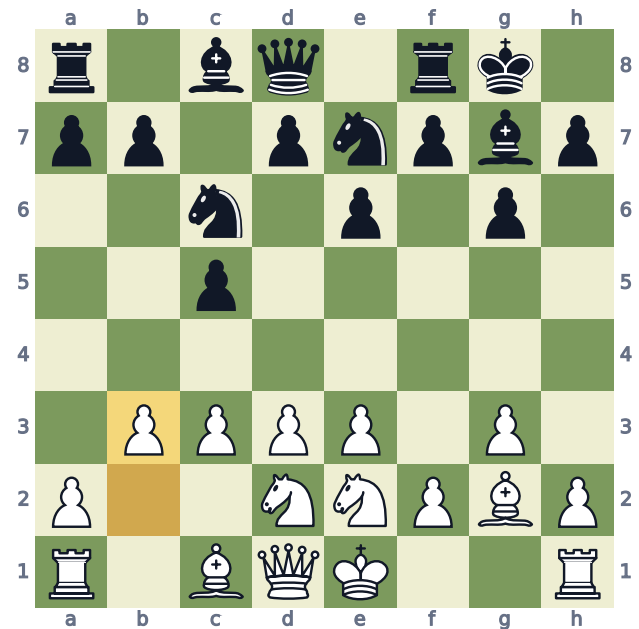
d5 can equalize before White claims the center.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Close the long diagonal before b3.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

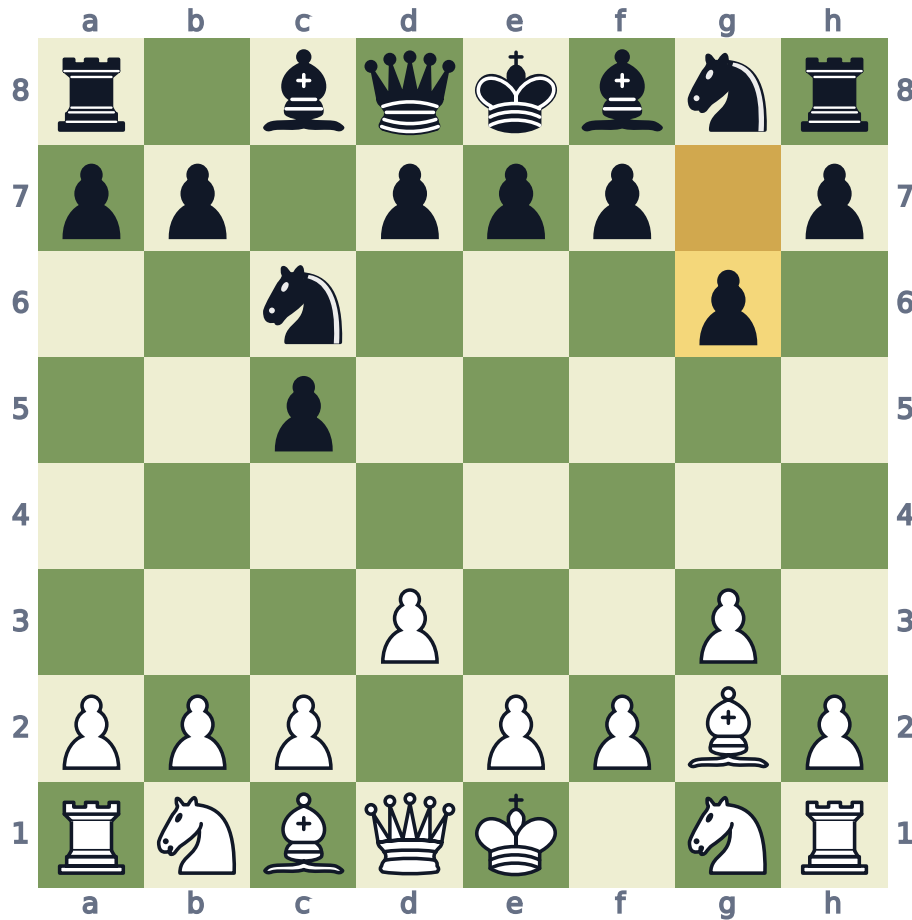
Position estimate: -0.46 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. d5 O-O 2. b5 Bb2 3. Qb6 Qc2 4. Rd8 a3 5. e5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Sicilian fianchetto core



YOUR TASK

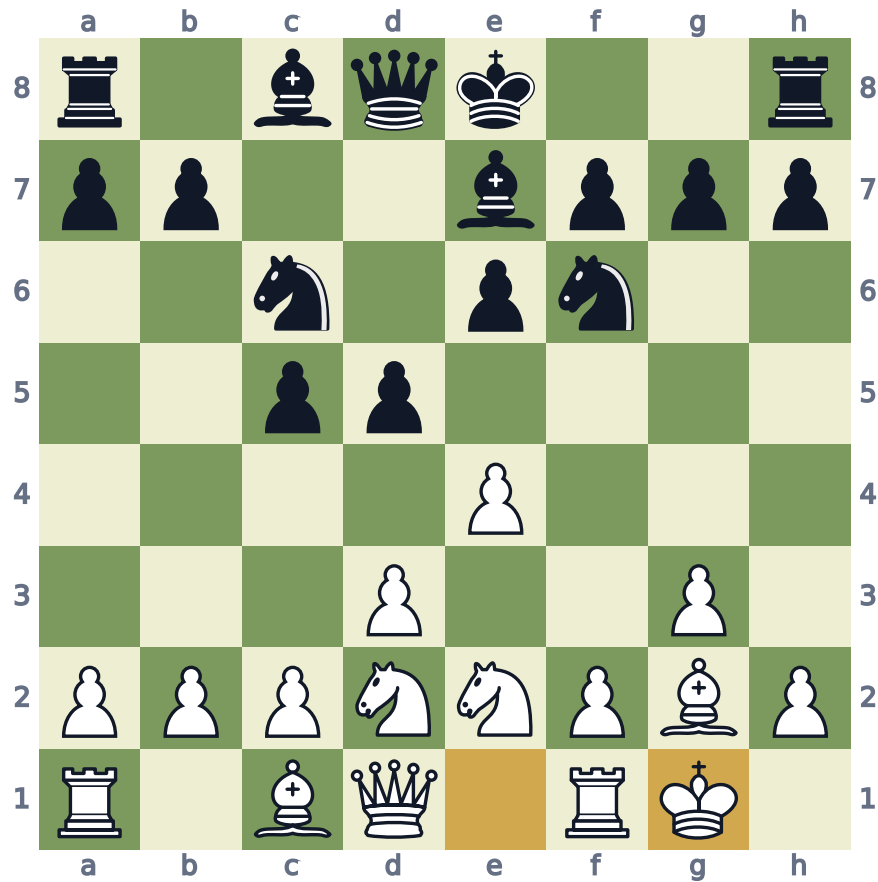
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Sicilian with e6 and d5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 e6 4. Nd2 d5 5. e4 Nf6 6. Ne2 Be7 7. O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

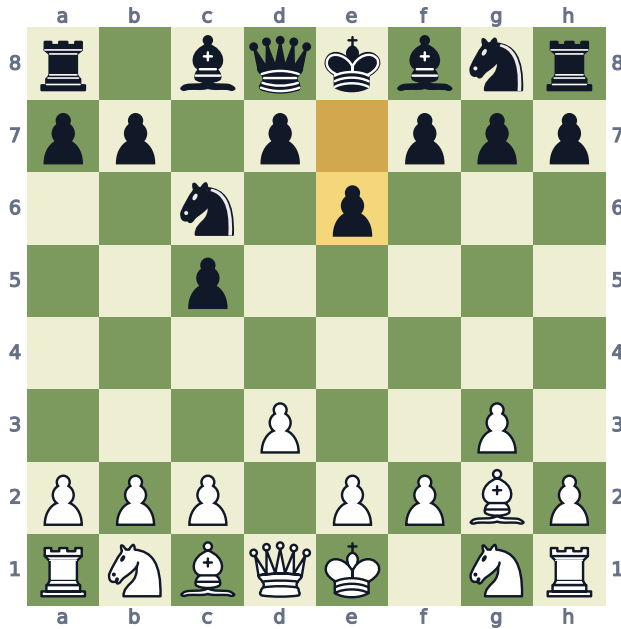
Build a Closed Sicilian center and prepare f4 or c3.

MAIN DANGER

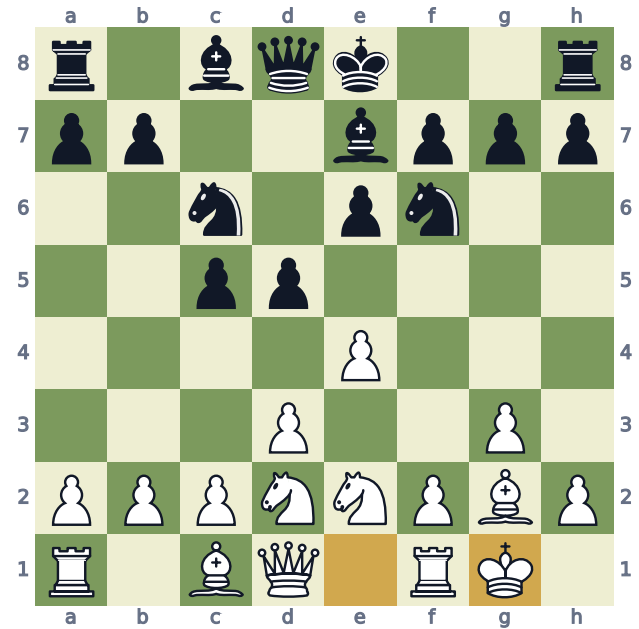
d4 can close space and restrict both knights.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against e6-d5, e4 fixes a target and keeps f4 available.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

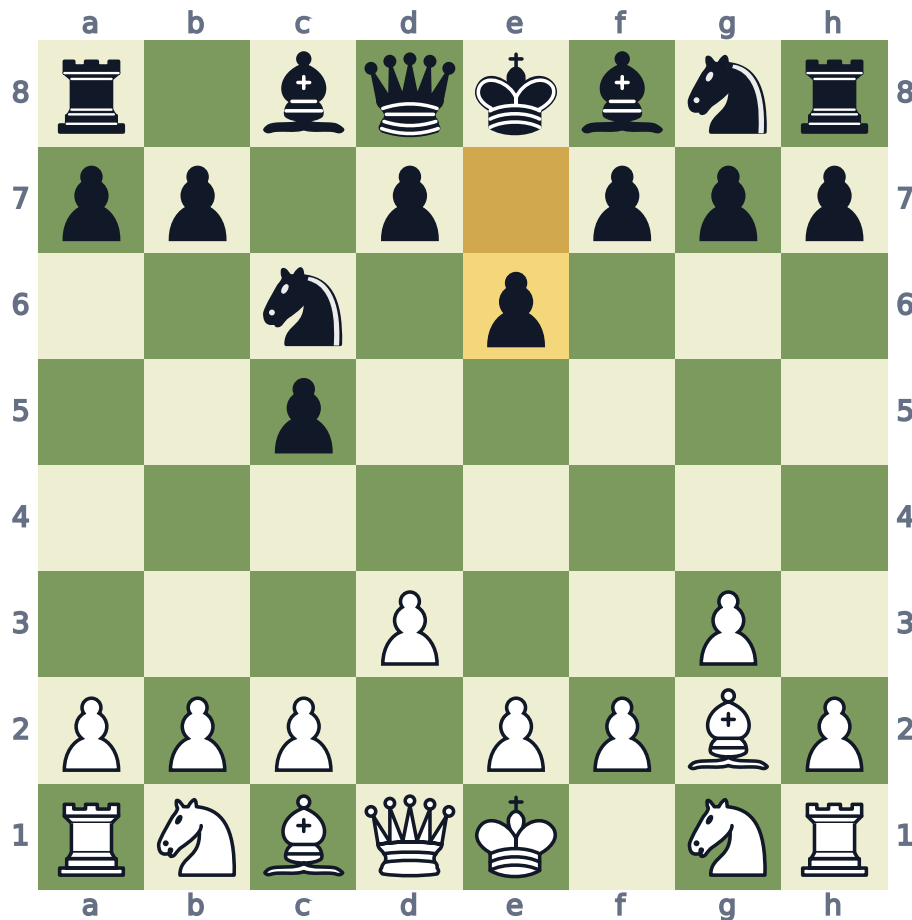
Position estimate: -0.14 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. O-O Re1 2. e5 exd5 3. Nxd5 Nc3 4. Be6 Nc4 5. f6 f4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Sicilian with e6 and d5



YOUR TASK

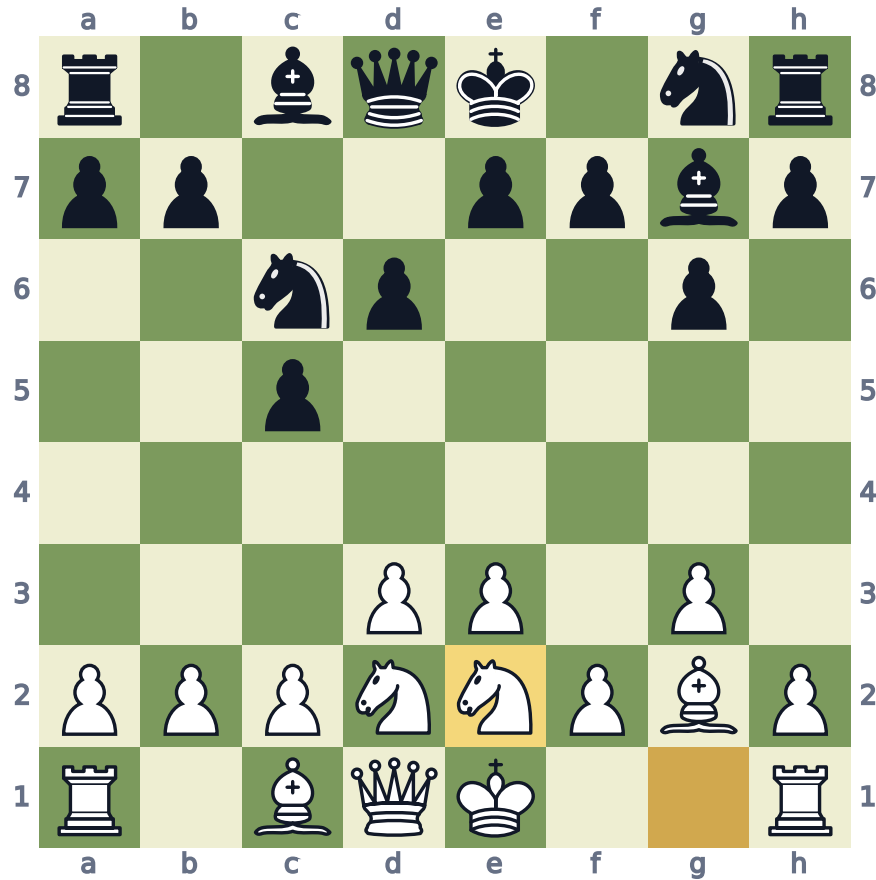
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Sicilian with d6 and g6



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 d6 3. d3 Nc6 4. Nd2 g6 5. e3 Bg7 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

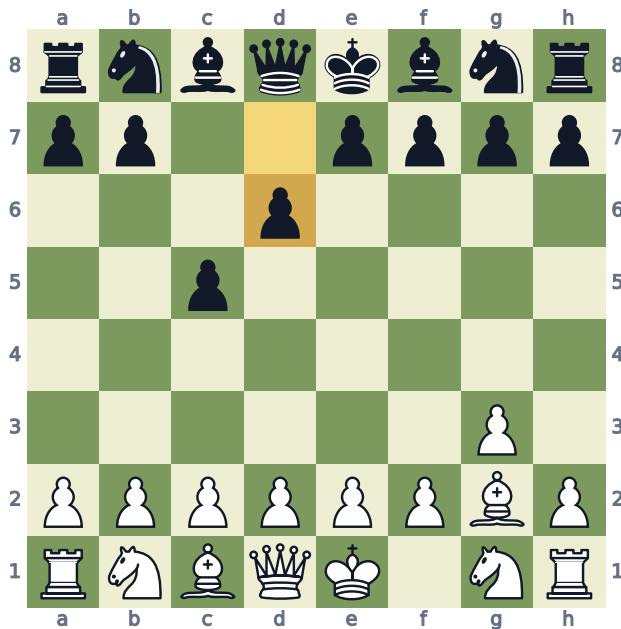
Keep the center flexible and prepare e4 or c3-d4.

MAIN DANGER

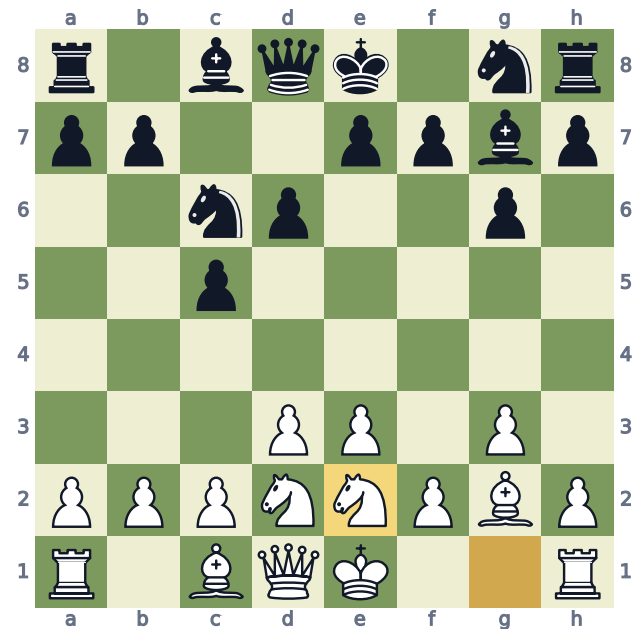
Black may play e5 or h5 before White acts.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A slow Sicilian setup gives choice, not unlimited time.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

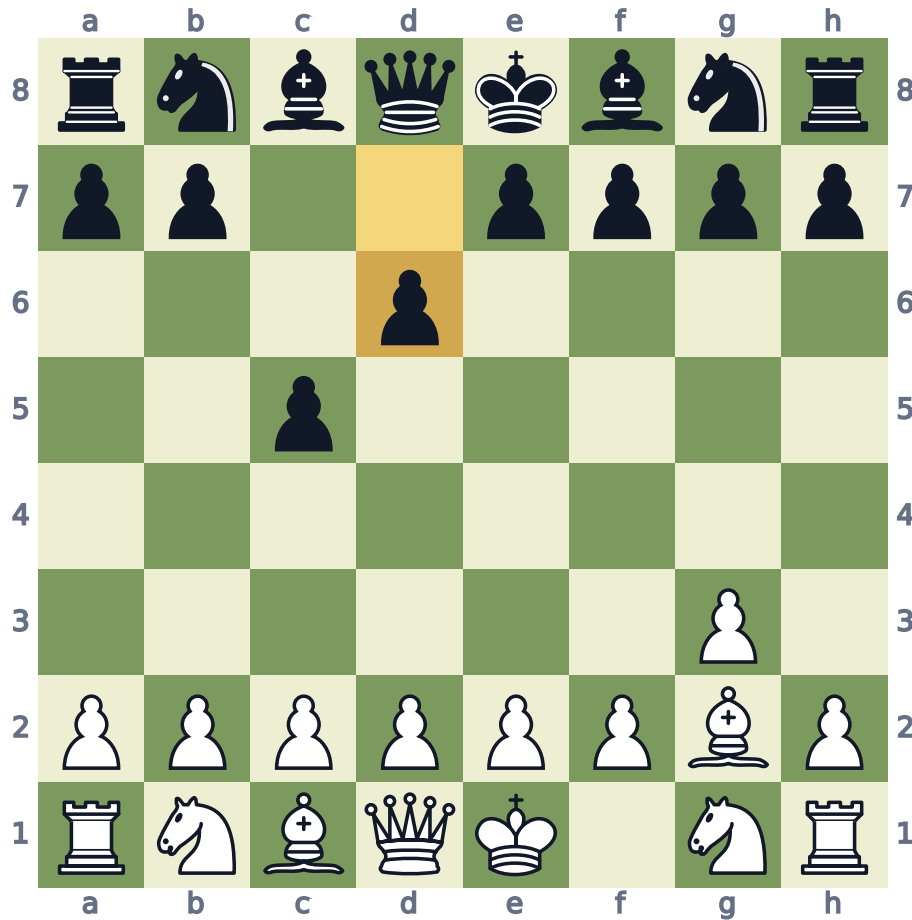
Position estimate: -0.42 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nf6 O-O 2. O-O c4 3. d5 d4 4. cxd4 cxd5 5. Nxd5 Nxd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Sicilian with d6 and g6



YOUR TASK

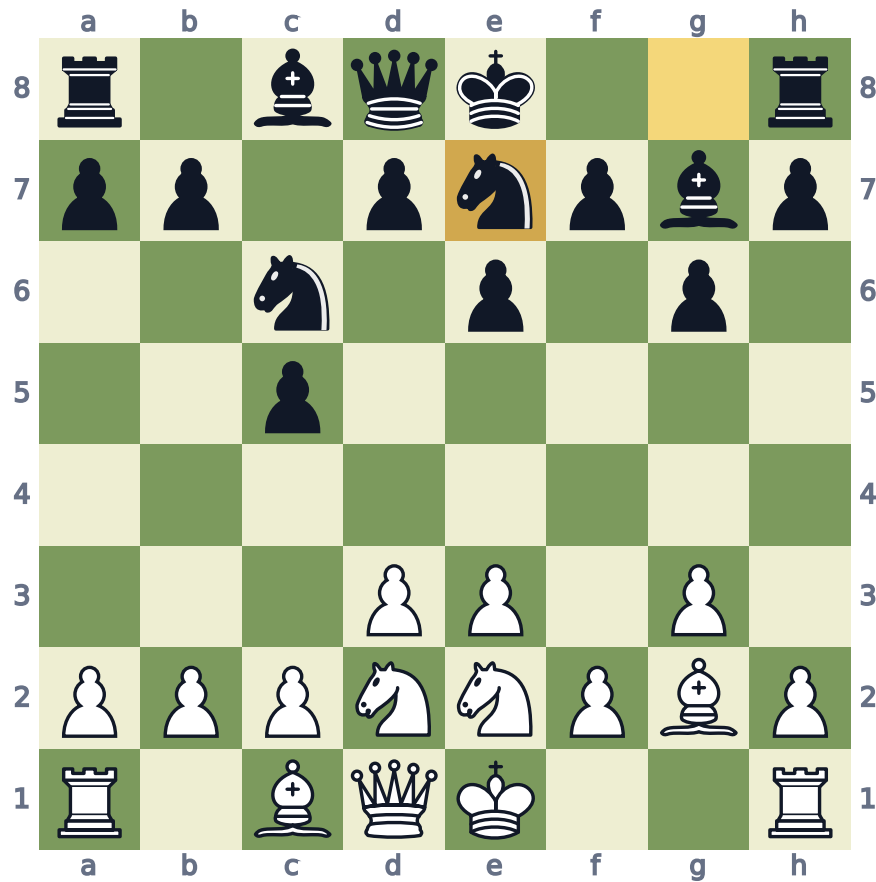
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Immediate g6 setup



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 Nc6 5. e3 e6 6. Ne2 Nge7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

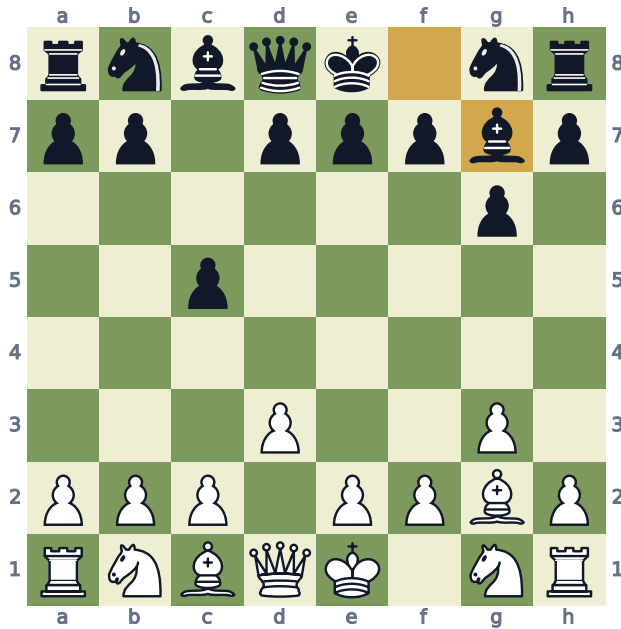
Prepare c3 and d4 while controlling the long diagonal.

MAIN DANGER

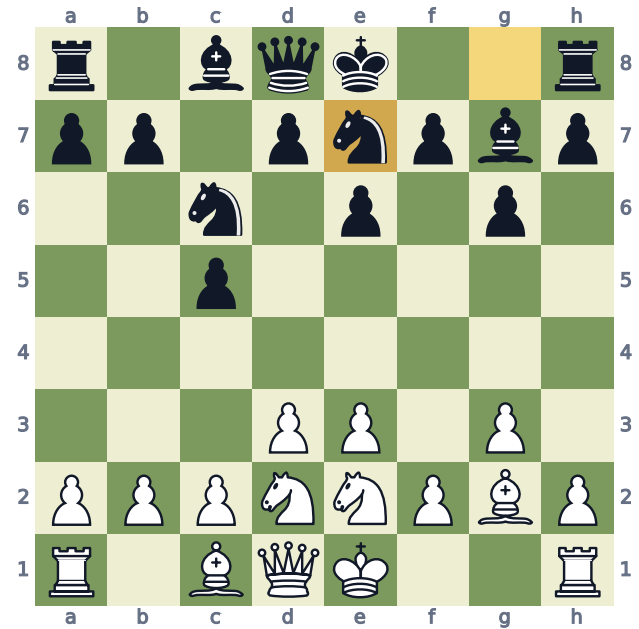
d5 can arrive in one move and equalize.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against the accelerated fianchetto, count tempi to d5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

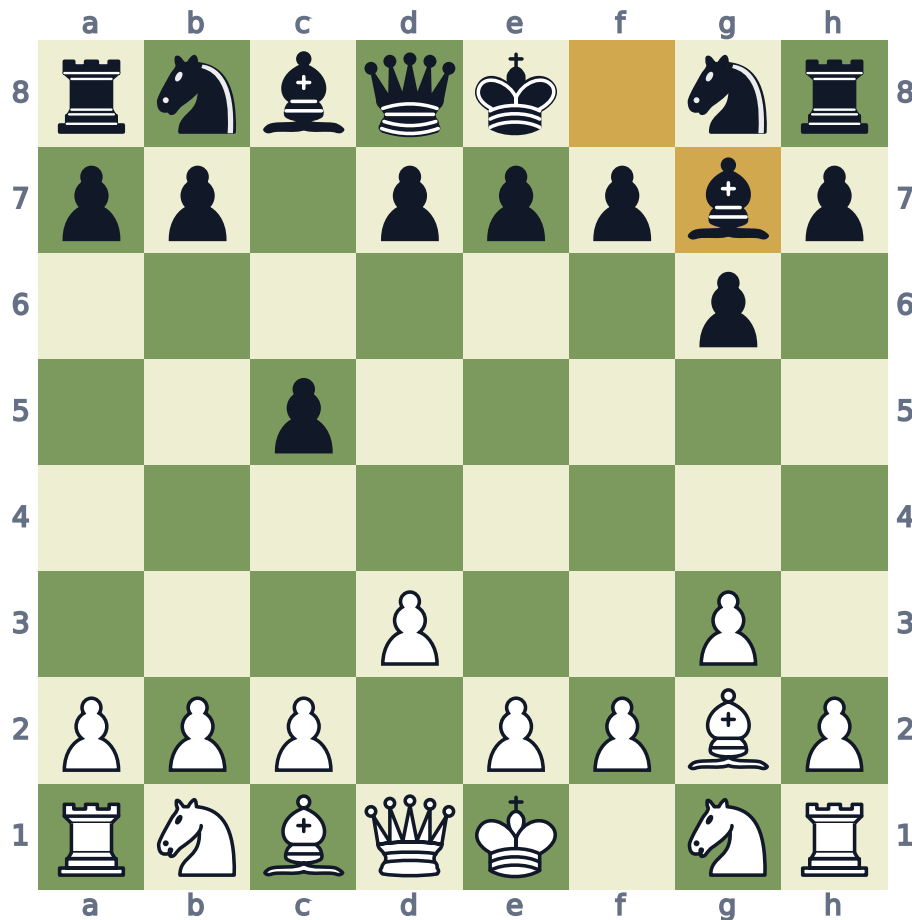
Position estimate: -0.44 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. O-O d5 2. Rb1 O-O 3. b3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Immediate g6 setup



YOUR TASK

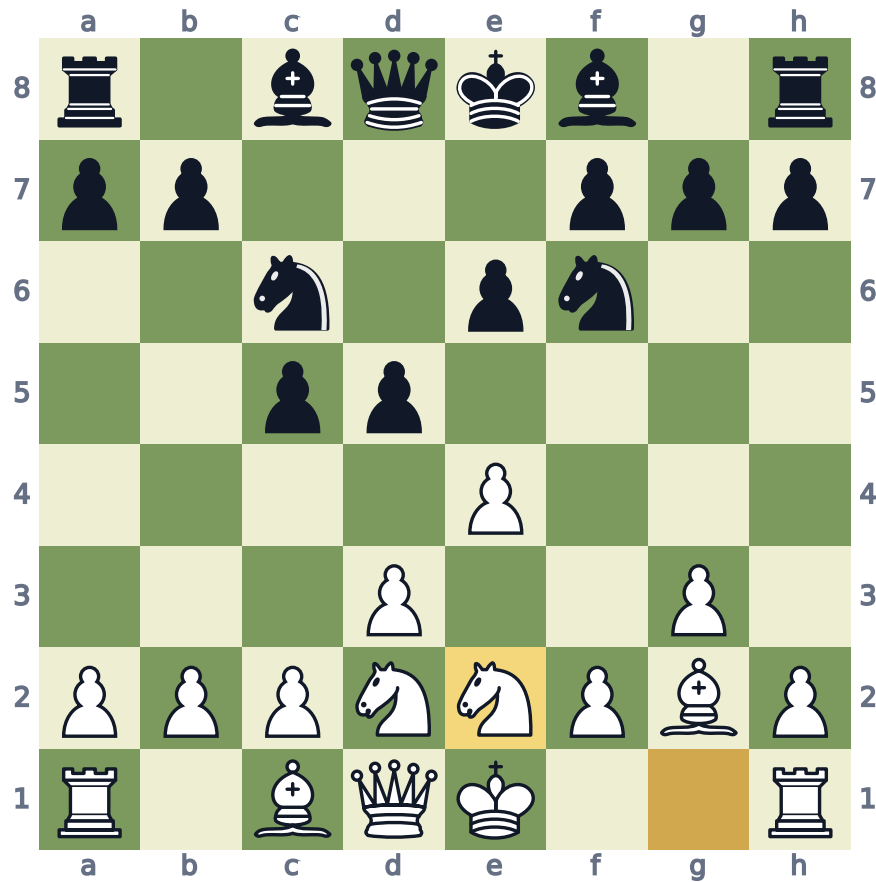
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Sicilian with Nf6 and d5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Nc6 5. e4 e6 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

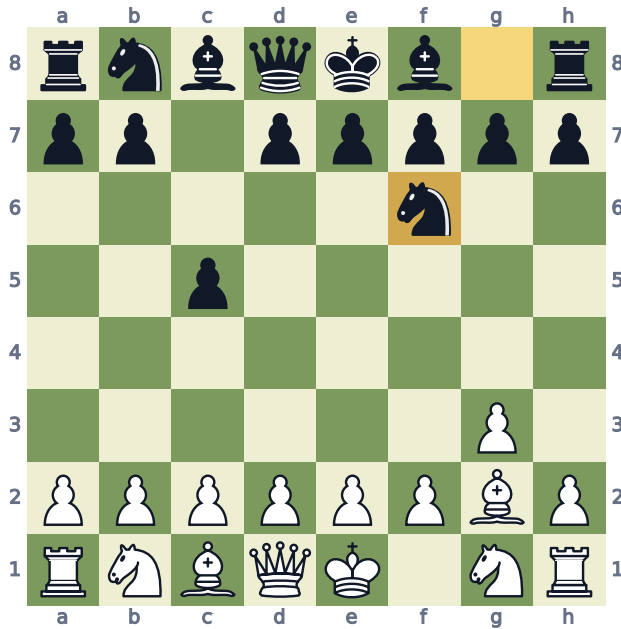
Use e4 to restrain d5 and prepare f4 or c3.

MAIN DANGER

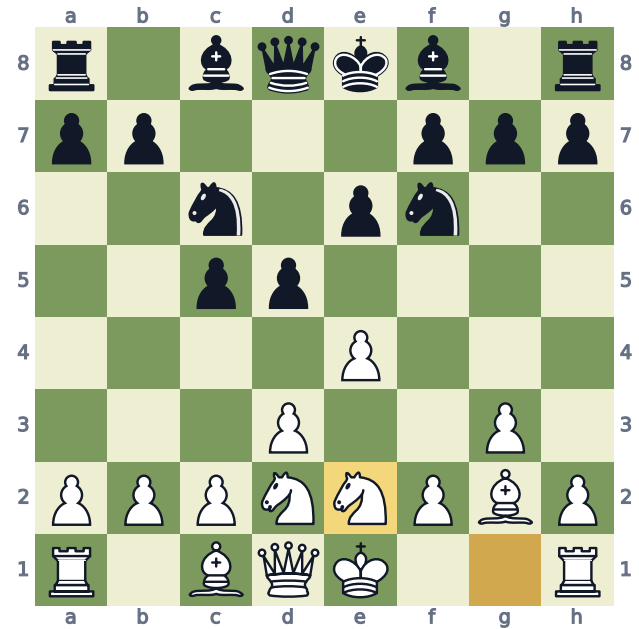
d4 can close the center and give Black queenside space.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When Nf6 supports d5, contact the center immediately.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

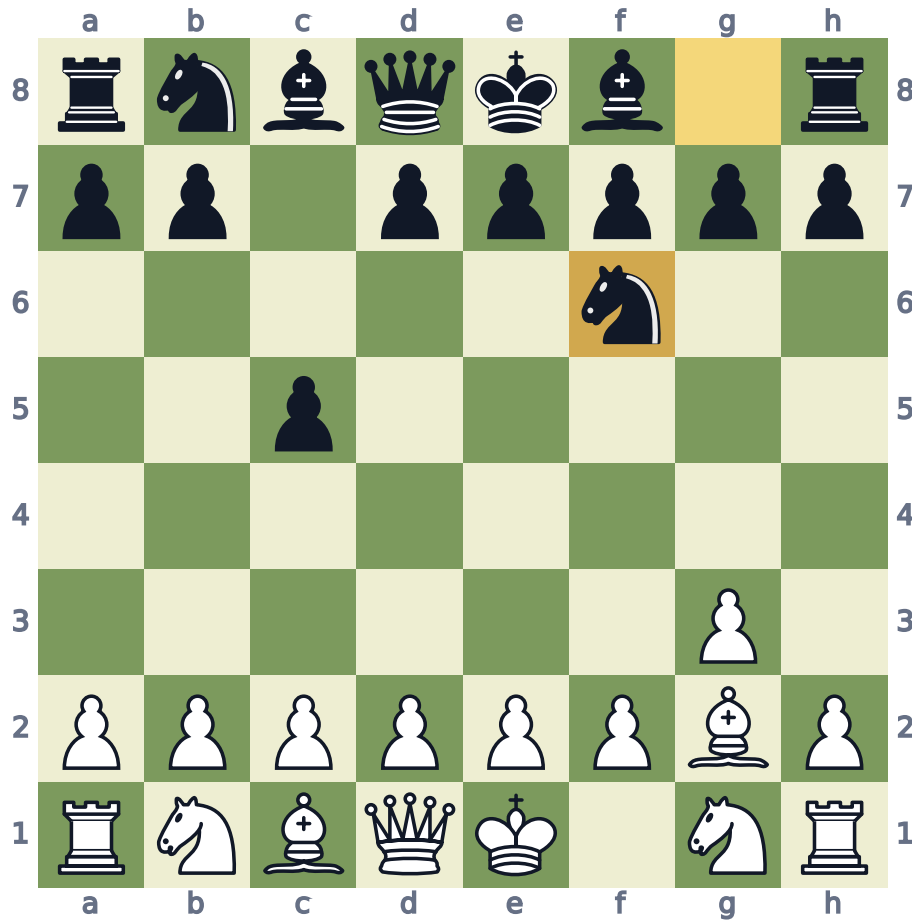
Position estimate: -0.19 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. Be7 O-O 2. O-O Re1 3. e5 exd5 4. Nxd5 Nc3 5. Be6 Nc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Sicilian with Nf6 and d5



YOUR TASK

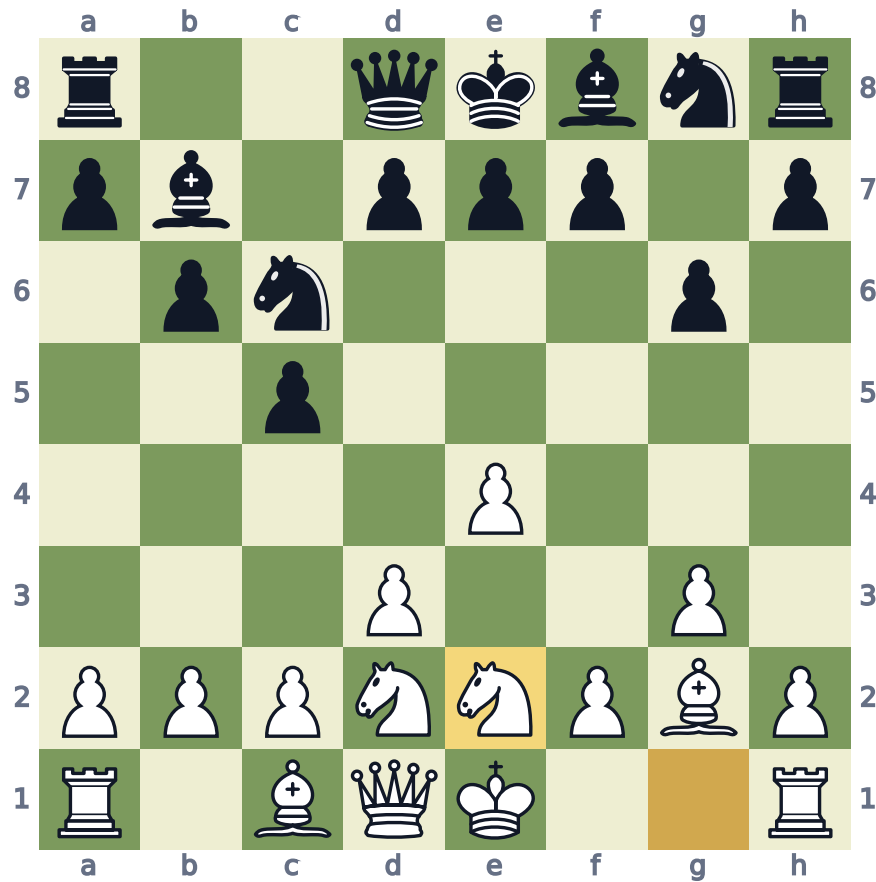
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Sicilian queenside fianchetto



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 b6 4. Nd2 Bb7 5. e4 g6 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

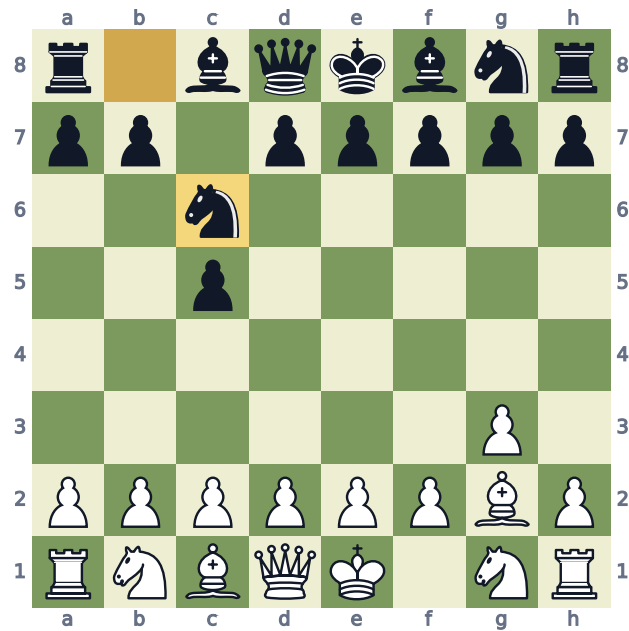
Use Nc6 to block the a1 diagonal, then occupy e4 before it opens.

MAIN DANGER

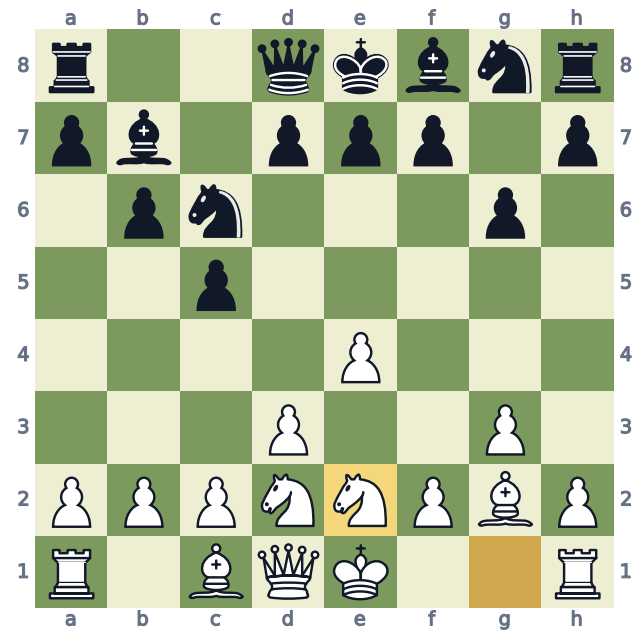
d5 can strike e4 and uncover the bishop.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Before b6, Black must block the diagonal; White should punish the move order if not.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

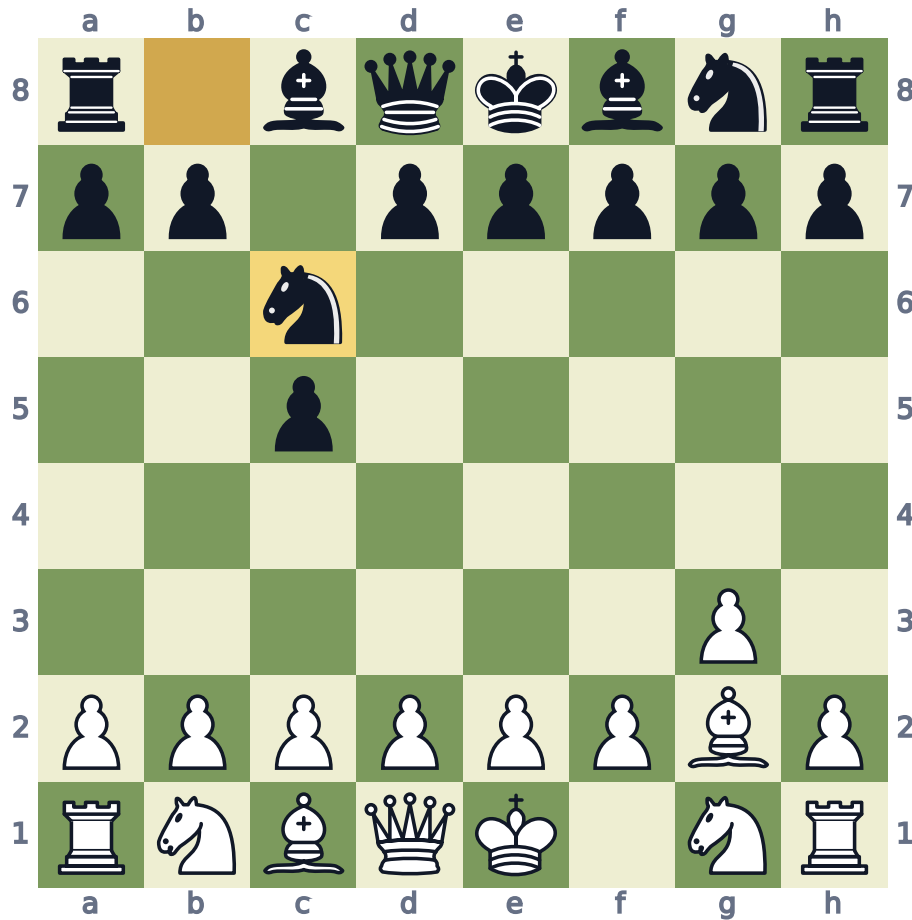
Position estimate: -0.04 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. Bg7 c3 2. Nf6 O-O 3. d6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Sicilian queenside fianchetto



YOUR TASK

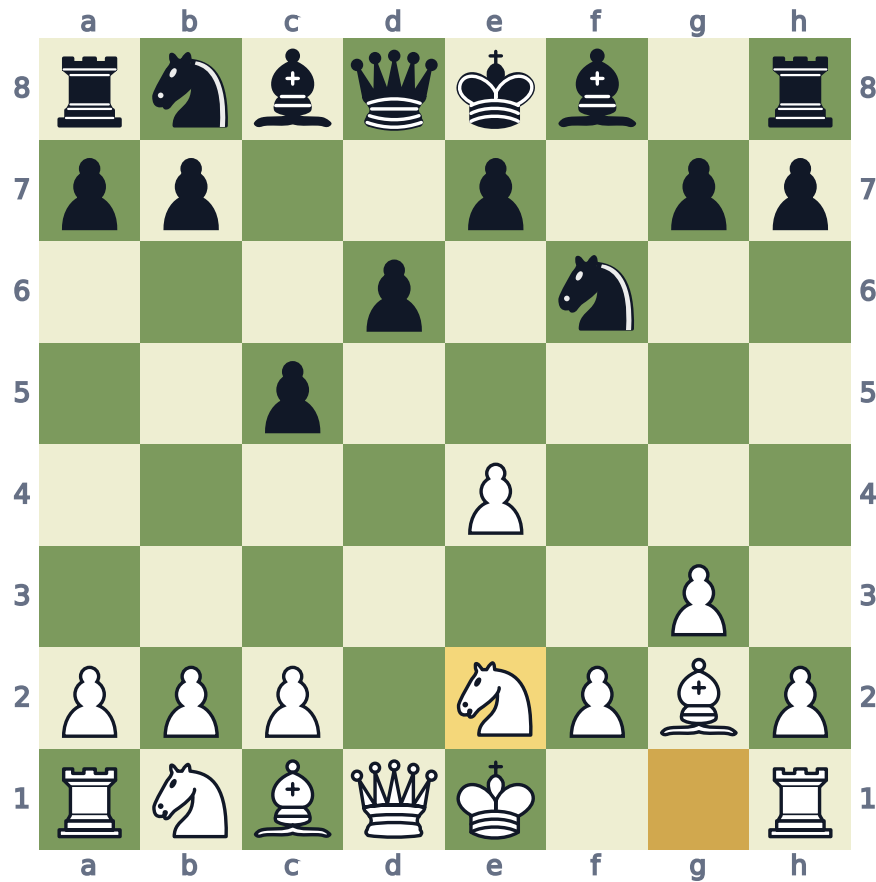
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Sicilian f5 structure



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 f5 3. d3 Nf6 4. e4 fxe4 5. dxe4 d6 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

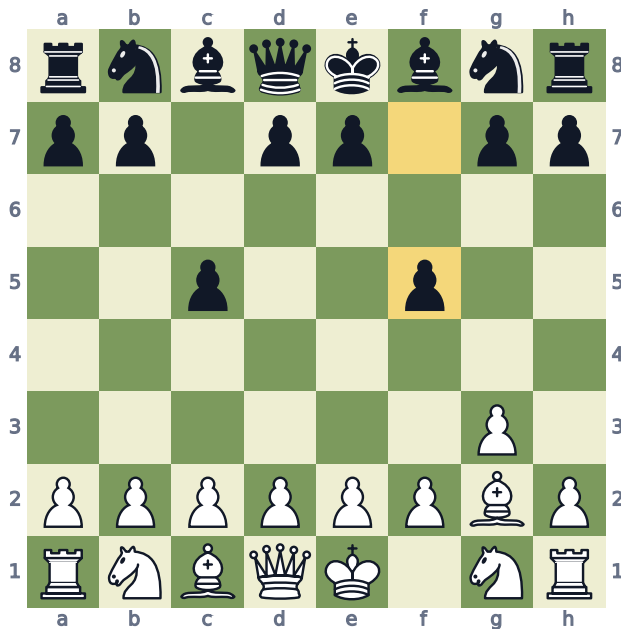
Exchange the advanced f-pawn and develop behind the opened center.

MAIN DANGER

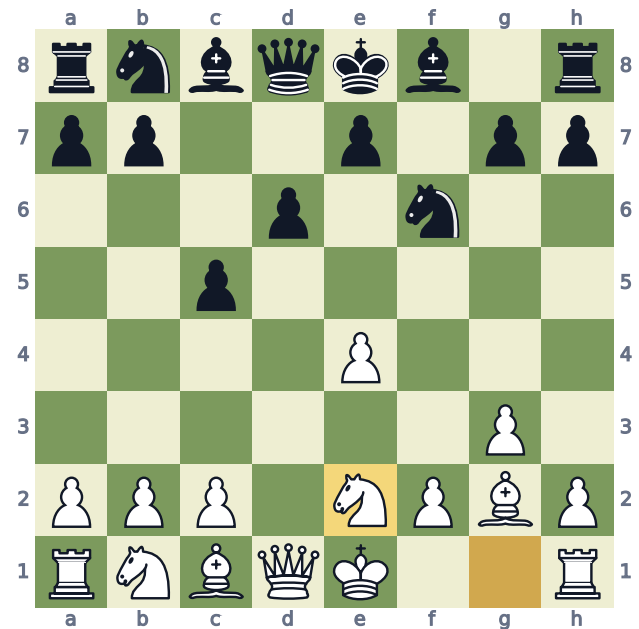
Black may use e5 and Nc6 with tempo.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against f5, central clarity is safer than passive shell-building.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

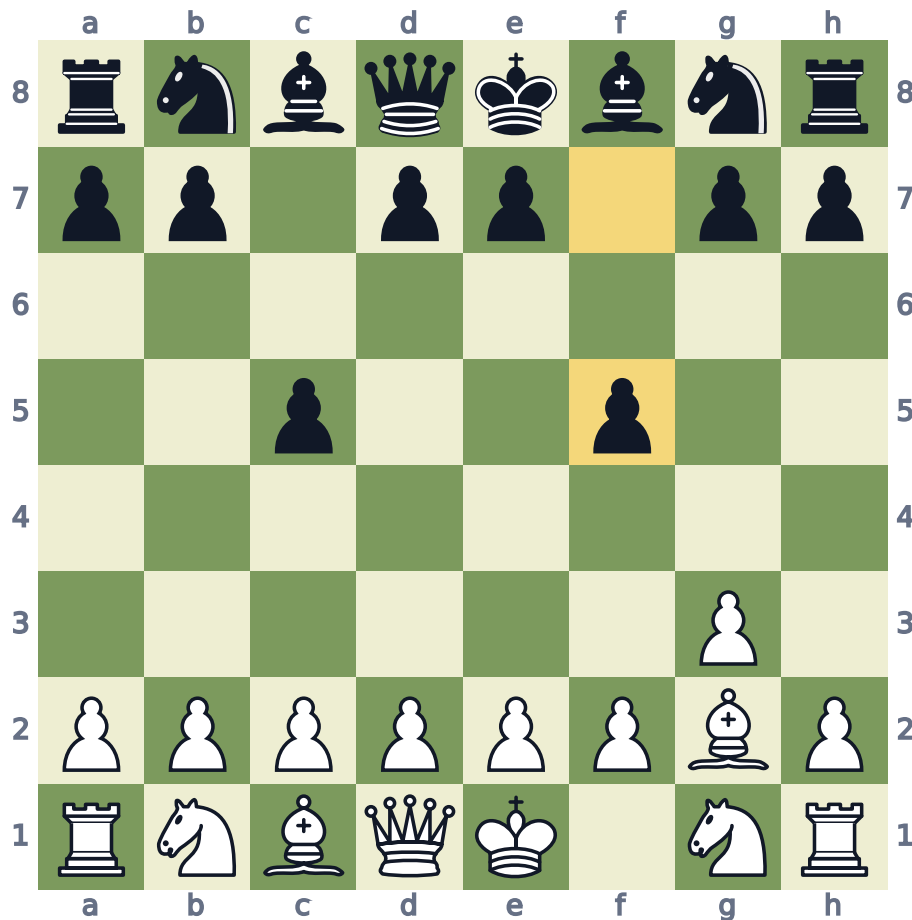
Position estimate: +0.58 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. g6 Nbc3 2. Nc6 Nd5 3. Bg7 O-O 4. O-O a4 5. Kh8 h3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Sicilian f5 structure



YOUR TASK

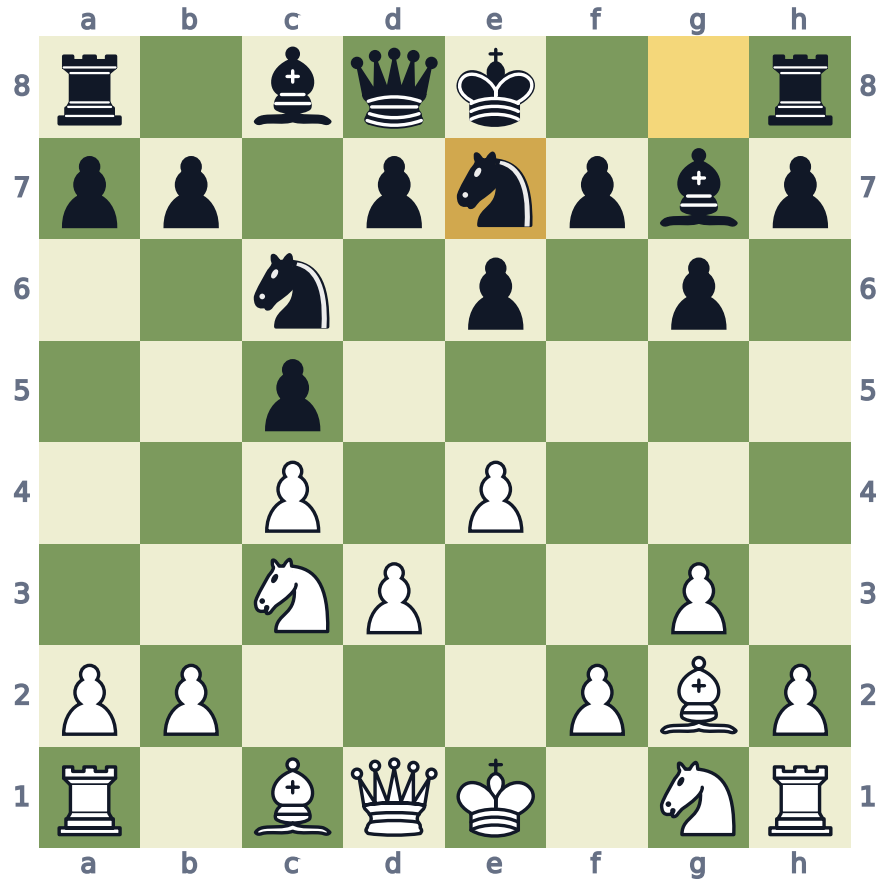
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Reversed Closed Sicilian



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. c4 g6 4. Nc3 Bg7 5. d3 e6 6. e4 Nge7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

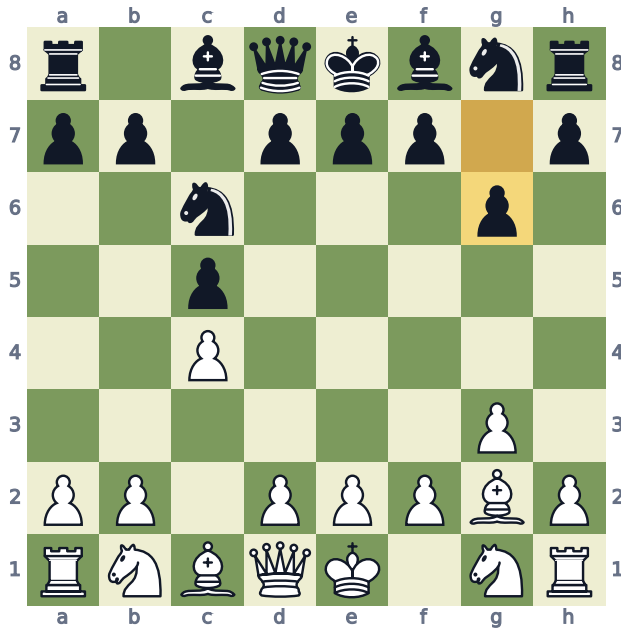
Use the extra tempo for a Botvinnik structure and prepare f4.

MAIN DANGER

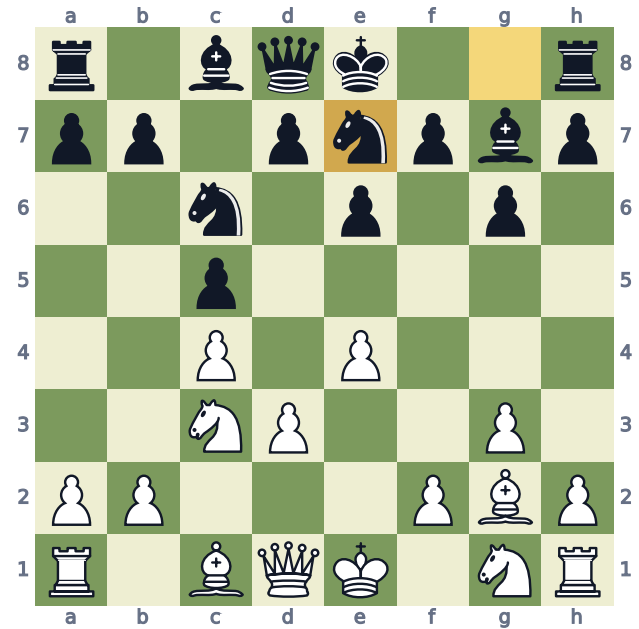
d5 or f5 can challenge the fixed center.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

c4-e4 controls d5 but creates a long-term d4 hole.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

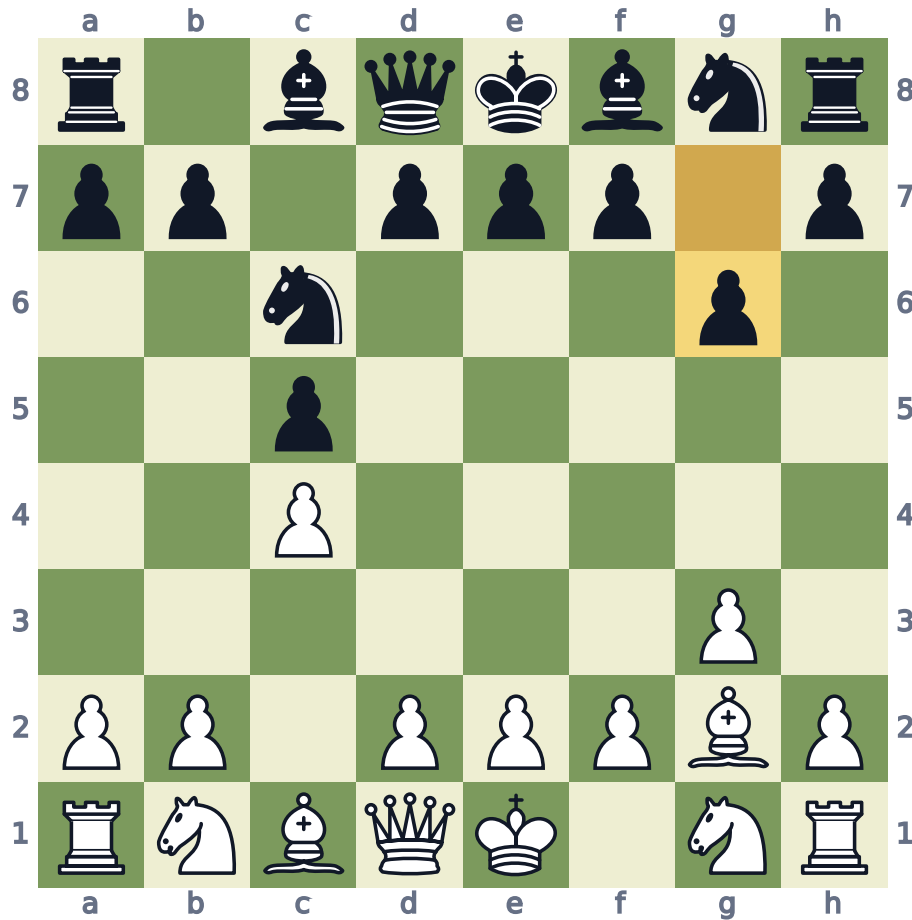
Position estimate: +0.09 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. Nge2 b6 2. Rb1 Bb7 3. Be3 Nd4 4. h4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Reversed Closed Sicilian



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. SICILIAN FIANCHETTO CORE

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use c3 to secure a1 and prepare d4 or e4. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Nf6 2. e4 Bg7 3. Nge2 d6 4. O-O Rb8 5. Nd5 O-O (+0.04 for White (equal)). Warning: d5 can equalize before White claims the center.

02. SICILIAN WITH E6 AND D5

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Build a Closed Sicilian center and prepare f4 or c3. Engine comparison: 1. e4 d5 2. exd5 exd5 3. Ne2 Be7 4. O-O Nf6 5. h3 O-O (+0.17 for White (equal)). Warning: d4 can close space and restrict both knights.

03. SICILIAN WITH D6 AND G6

Course move: d3. Purpose: Keep the center flexible and prepare e4 or c3-d4. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 g6 2. d4 cxd4 3. Nxd4 Bg7 4. O-O Nf6 5. c4 (+0.52 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black may play e5 or h5 before White acts.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. IMMEDIATE G6 SETUP

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Prepare c3 and d4 while controlling the long diagonal. Engine comparison: 1. c4 e6 2. Nc3 Ne7 3. e4 d6 4. Nge2 Nbc6 5. Be3 (+0.12 for White (equal)). Warning: d5 can arrive in one move and equalize.

05. SICILIAN WITH NF6 AND D5

Course move: d3. Purpose: Use e4 to restrain d5 and prepare f4 or c3. Engine comparison: 1. c4 e6 2. Nf3 Be7 3. Nc3 d5 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. d4 Nxc3 (+0.38 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can close the center and give Black queenside space.

06. SICILIAN QUEENSIDE FIANCHETTO

Course move: d3. Purpose: Use Nc6 to block the a1 diagonal, then occupy e4 before it opens. Engine comparison: 1. c4 g6 2. Nc3 Bg7 3. Nf3 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d4 O-O (+0.29 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d5 can strike e4 and uncover the bishop.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. SICILIAN F5 STRUCTURE

Course move: d3. Purpose: Exchange the advanced f-pawn and develop behind the opened center. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Nc6 2. d4 cxd4 3. Nxd4 g6 4. c4 Bg7 5. Be3 Nf6 (+0.70 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black may use e5 and Nc6 with tempo.

08. REVERSED CLOSED SICILIAN

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Use the extra tempo for a Botvinnik structure and prepare f4. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Bg7 2. Nf3 d6 3. O-O Rb8 4. e3 Nf6 5. d4 O-O (+0.32 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d5 or f5 can challenge the fixed center.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.